- `DeveloperExceptionPageMiddleware`—Provides quick error feedback when building an application
- `ExceptionHandlerMiddleware`—Provides a generic error page in production so that you don't leak any sensitive details

You won't see how to build your own middleware in this chapter; instead, you'll see that you can go a long way by using the components provided as part of ASP.NET Core. When you understand the middleware pipeline and its behavior, you'll find it much easier to understand when and why custom middleware is required. With that in mind, let's dive in!

4.1 Defining middleware

The word *middleware* is used in a variety of contexts in software development and IT, but it's not a particularly descriptive word.

In ASP.NET Core, *middleware* is a C# class[1] that can handle an HTTP request or response. Middleware can

- Handle an incoming HTTP *request* by generating an HTTP *response*
- Process an incoming HTTP *request*, modify it, and pass it on to another piece of middleware
- Process an outgoing HTTP *response*, modify it, and pass it on to another piece of middleware or to the ASP.NET Core web server

You can use middleware in a multitude of ways in your own applications. A piece of logging middleware, for example, might note when a request